

Saiph Lovelace — Cosmic Affinity, Manifesting as Fire

Core rules and progression

Stage	How his magic appears
Early Strings	Flame, warmth, brilliant light, and circling embers. “Fire” is a reasonable interpretation.
Developing Strings	Light splits into colors; motes follow precise orbits; distant points connect; a flame carries its own pocket of air. “Fire” no longer explains everything.
Revelatory Strings	Weight shifts, light disappears behind an eclipse, and clouds of luminous material take shape. The original classification becomes impossible to maintain.
Nova	A controlled <i>possibility</i> for future mastery. The cove’s sapphire-to-white event remains an uncontrolled story event, not a PL 5 spell Saiph already knows.

PL is Power Level; **TP/DC** are proposed Tension cost and Thread Check DC. Saves against a row’s DC halve its listed damage and prevent its listed condition. No String creates an actual star, black hole, limitless oxygen supply, or world-ending explosion.

1. The Corona String — POT

His awakening String. A central spark casts a circular edge of heat and light. As his control improves, Saiph learns that the edge can define a safe center instead of merely burning whatever it reaches.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Flame gathers at his hand and traces a ring up to 5 ft

		in radius on a surface he can see. It lasts until his next turn. A creature crossing the ring takes 1d6 fire damage on a failed RES save. This is the form that manifested around him at seven.
2	2 / 13	Extends the ring to 10 ft, lasting 3 rounds. He can direct most of its heat outward, sheltering people in its center from the ring itself. Fuel touching its outside can still ignite.
3	4 / 15	Makes an irregular corona up to 20 ft across for 1 minute while concentrating. It can enclose a group or block an approach; crossing its edge deals 3d6 fire damage on a failed RES save.
4	6 / 17	Maintains two smaller coronas or one 30-ft corona for 3 rounds. Once each turn he can open and close one safe passage through an edge.
5	9 / 19	Compresses the outer edge until it flashes blue-white, then expands it across a 30-ft area. Creatures caught on the moving edge take 6d6 radiant/fire damage on a failed RES save. He may leave chosen spaces in the

		center untouched.
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2. The Starheart String — CTR

The stable center. Saiph holds a dense point of energy steady and meters out its light and heat. This is his constructive alternative to thinking fire only destroys.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Holds a warm, palm-sized point of light for 1 hour . It can illuminate a room, warm hands, or heat a small meal gradually without a spreading flame.
2	2 / 13	Maintains a stable source of warmth in a 10-ft area for 1 hour , or releases its stored heat in one 2d6 fire-damage strike within 15 ft. Releasing it ends the warmth.
3	4 / 15	Keeps a 20-ft shelter warm and lit for 8 hours , or forms a compact radiant point that deals 3d6 radiant/fire damage to one target. It still consumes air when used to maintain ordinary burning.
4	6 / 17	Splits one stable center into up to three smaller lights , each independently dimmed or warmed, for 1 hour . In combat, he can collapse them into a single 4d8 radiant/fire strike.

5	9 / 19	Sustains a brilliant, controlled center that can light a district landmark or keep a sizable shelter warm for 8 hours . If deliberately discharged, it deals 6d8 radiant/fire damage to one target; the sustained effect ends.
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3. The Spectrum String — CTR

Starlight has more than one face. Saiph separates radiance into bands of color and intensity. The unusual colors are part of the same Affinity, not a second one.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Changes the color of one magical light or flame he controls for 10 minutes . He can distinguish details that ordinary orange firelight washes out, gaining Harmony on one visual examination.
2	2 / 13	Splits light across a reflective surface into a visible spectrum. For 1 minute , he can pick out fresh disturbances—dust, heat traces, or a recently handled surface—if there is enough light to inspect them.
3	4 / 15	Sends a narrow beam of concentrated radiance up to 30 ft for 3d6 radiant damage , or uses it for 1

		minute to inspect markings and materials under different bands of light. It cannot read an erased memory or see through a wall.
4	6 / 17	Bends several bands independently across a 15-ft area . He can expose a visually concealed object whose camouflage depends on ordinary light, or dazzle creatures in the area; on a failed RES save, they are Blinded for 1 round .
5	9 / 19	Compresses the spectrum into a brief blue-white beam for 6d8 radiant damage to one target, or spreads it across a 30-ft area to reveal light-based disguises and false images for 1 minute . It does not reveal every form of magic.

4. The Orbit String — CTR

Objects and motes move around a chosen center. Orbit governs paths and interception; unlike Gravity, it does not change what something weighs.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Circles a mote of light or one tiny unattended object around his hand for 1 minute . It can illuminate several angles of a small

		mechanism while he works.
2	2 / 13	Keeps up to three notes circling himself or an adjacent ally for 3 rounds . The first incoming projectile is knocked off course, reducing its damage by 1d6 .
3	4 / 15	Establishes a moving orbit up to 10 ft across for 1 minute while concentrating. He can move small loose objects safely around a central obstacle or reduce one visible projectile hit per round by 2d6 .
4	6 / 17	Places protective orbits around up to three allies within 20 ft for 3 rounds . Each orbit reduces its first projectile hit by 2d6 ; a spent orbit goes dark.
5	9 / 19	Redirects the path of one visible, externally traveling physical attack or String of PL 5 or lower around a chosen center. Reduce its damage by 5d8 ; if reduced to zero, he can send its remaining momentum harmlessly into terrain rather than automatically striking someone else.

5. The Constellation String — THS

Separate points become a readable whole. Constellation supports navigation, coordination, and finding people—not omniscience. Its strength fits a boy who once worked best with a friend and an adult who tries to keep everyone accounted for.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Places up to three faint points of light on surfaces he touches. For 1 hour , he can recognize their direction from within 60 ft , making a simple route back through confusing streets.
2	3 / 14	Links up to three willing people or marked positions within 30 ft for 10 minutes . Each can see the direction of the other linked points while in range; it does not transmit speech or thoughts.
3	5 / 16	Maps up to six marked points across a 120-ft area for 1 hour , noticing if one moves or goes out of range. In combat, linked allies gain Harmony on one coordinated movement check .
4	7 / 18	Creates a temporary route of lights across a 300-ft area for 1 hour . Willing people he has linked can follow it even through smoke or poor visibility, provided the physical route remains passable.

5	10 / 20	Holds a living map of up to ten willing linked allies or marked locations within 500 ft for 10 minutes while concentrating. Once each round, he can guide one linked ally to move 10 ft without provoking a reaction from a creature that cannot see the link.
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6. The Vacuum String — CTR

The space around a flame matters. Saiph can briefly separate a pocket from surrounding air or water, preserving or starving combustion. This develops the small air bubble around his underwater flame in the backstory.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Protects a tiny flame in a pocket of air for a few seconds , even beneath water. It goes out when the pocket empties. He can also snuff a candle by denying it air.
2	3 / 14	Keeps a fist-sized object dry or an ember lit beneath water for 1 minute while concentrating. It does not provide enough air for a person to breathe.
3	5 / 16	Creates a 5-ft pocket for 3 rounds that pushes aside smoke, spray, or loose dust. It makes a temporary clear working space but supplies no fresh air to an enclosed

		room.
4	7 / 18	Separates a 10-ft area from surrounding smoke or water for 3 rounds . It can protect a brief passage or suppress ordinary flame crossing its edge. An unwilling creature inside can leave normally; it is not a suffocation attack.
5	10 / 20	Maintains a 15-ft protected pocket for 1 minute while concentrating. It can hold back water or hazardous smoke long enough for an evacuation, but pressure on its boundary remains and the pocket fails if he loses control.

7. The Meteor String — POT

A falling point of light becomes an impact. Meteor is Saiph's direct offensive String. It combines heat with trajectory and force; it is not just a larger fireball.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 12	Drops a bright mote onto one visible target within 30 ft for 1d6 bludgeoning + 1d6 fire damage .
2	3 / 14	Directs a mote around one ordinary obstacle before impact for 2d6 bludgeoning + 1d6 fire damage . It still needs a plausible visible path.

3	4 / 16	Calls a denser falling point onto a 5-ft area for 3d6 bludgeoning + 2d6 fire damage on a failed RES save. Loose objects may scatter.
4	6 / 18	Sends up to three smaller impacts into a 20-ft area . Divide 6d6 combined bludgeoning/fire damage among targets there; no one target can receive more than half the pool.
5	9 / 20	Strikes a 15-ft-radius area with a controlled meteor-like descent for 8d6 combined bludgeoning/fire damage on a failed RES save. The impact can damage ordinary structures; Saiph must account for what is below them.

8. The Stellar Wind String — POT

A directed flow of luminous, charged force. It appears as flying sparks and ribbons of flame, but its main action is to **push, carry, and deflect**. It does not give Saiph a Lightning Affinity.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Pushes loose ash, smoke, or a lightweight object 5 ft , or gives a willing adjacent person a small nudge out of danger.
2	2 / 13	Sends a bright current down a 15-ft line .

		Creatures failing a POT save are pushed 10 ft and take 1d6 radiant damage .
3	4 / 15	Carries Saiph or a willing adjacent ally up to 20 ft in a straight burst with a safe landing place, or pushes enemies in a 15-ft cone for 2d6 radiant damage and 10 ft of movement.
4	6 / 17	Directs several flowing ribbons across a 20-ft area for 3 rounds . Allies moving with them gain Harmony on one movement check each round; enemies crossing against them make a POT save or are pushed 15 ft .
5	9 / 19	Releases a luminous current in a 30-ft cone for 5d8 radiant damage and a 20-ft push on a failed POT save. He can instead shape the current to carry up to three willing allies across a 30-ft gap.

9. The Gravity String — POT

The pull beneath an orbit. This String changes local weight and attraction for a short time. It does not generate a black hole, crush an entire city, or manipulate every object at once.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 13	Makes a small unattended object feel unusually light or heavy for 1 minute , helping him lift or hold it in place.

2	4 / 15	Shifts the weight of one visible creature for 1 round . On a failed POT save, it has Discord on its next balance or movement check and its speed changes by 10 ft in Saiph's chosen direction.
3	6 / 17	Establishes a localized pull in a 10-ft area for 3 rounds . Creatures failing a POT save are drawn 10 ft toward its center when it forms; loose objects follow.
4	8 / 19	Lightens a willing ally for one controlled leap of up to 30 ft , or makes an enemy within 30 ft heavy enough to be Restrained for 1 round on a failed POT save.
5	11 / 21	Holds a 20-ft gravitational well for 3 rounds while concentrating. Enemies entering it make a POT save or are pulled 15 ft toward its center and have their speed halved there. Allies can cross if Saiph shapes a route, but unsecured objects still move.

10. The Eclipse String — THS

Light can be blocked as deliberately as it is made. Eclipse overlays a dark boundary upon radiance. It is not Shadow magic and does not erase Saiph's bird-call signature.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Dims one light he controls for 10 minutes , leaving just enough illumination for him to work nearby.
2	3 / 14	Places a moving patch of shade up to 5 ft across for 3 rounds , useful for obscuring a light source or protecting someone from glare.
3	5 / 16	Darkens a 15-ft area for 3 rounds while concentrating. Ordinary sight-based attacks into it have Discord unless the attacker has another way to locate the target.
4	7 / 18	Eclipses a visible magical light effect of PL 4 or lower for 1 round on an opposed Thread Check. He suppresses its illumination, not its unrelated effects.
5	10 / 20	Creates a controlled 20-ft eclipse for 3 rounds . Saiph can leave a narrow halo at its edge to guide allies while enemies within rely on other senses. The shade does not stop sound or grant automatic invisibility.

11. The Nebula String — CTR

Luminous dust, heated gas, and cloudlike shapes. Nebula gives Saiph shelter, misdirection, and visibility control. A bird-shaped cloud can be a motif; it is **not** automatically a real or sentient bird companion.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Suspends a small cloud of glowing dust or smoke for 1 minute . Its drift reveals airflow and moving bodies nearby.
2	3 / 14	Spreads a 10-ft cloud for 3 rounds . It lightly obscures those within and makes a useful visible signal, but also gives away its position.
3	5 / 16	Forms a 15-ft cloud for 1 minute while concentrating. Saiph can open one clear viewing lane through it each turn; other sightlines remain obscured.
4	7 / 18	Compresses the cloud into several luminous shapes or expands it across a 20-ft area for 3 rounds . Creatures entering an intensely heated portion take 3d6 radiant/fire damage on a failed RES save.
5	10 / 20	Holds a 30-ft nebula for 1 minute , dividing it into bright, dim, and obscured regions as he concentrates. Once during its duration he may collapse one bright region for 5d8 radiant damage to creatures within

		10 ft of it.
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12. The Nova String — POT

The dangerous release of a compressed center. Nova is the last String in this proposed roster because it challenges Saiph's need to control every outcome. It is **not** a reenactment of the cove: that sapphire-white event exceeded anything here and remains an unresolved, uncontrolled incident.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 13	Releases a compact flash from a light he already controls. It deals 1d6 radiant damage to one creature within 15 ft or serves as a brilliant one-second signal.
2	4 / 15	Compresses light for one round, then releases it in a 5-ft burst for 2d6 radiant + 1d6 fire damage on a failed RES save. The delay is visible and audible.
3	6 / 17	Releases a 10-ft burst for 4d6 radiant/fire damage . Before casting, Saiph must designate an unoccupied safe direction in which excess force escapes; without one, the Thread Check has Discord.
4	8 / 19	Forms a controlled 15-ft burst for 6d6 radiant/fire damage on a failed RES save. Saiph can spare a 5-ft space he can see, but cannot assume fragile

		surroundings will survive.
5	11 / 21	Compresses and releases a blue-white 20-ft burst for 8d8 radiant/fire damage on a failed RES save. Afterward Saiph gains Shaking Hands until his next Mend. It is powerful, visible, audible, and far smaller than the unexplained cove event.